



Krypton BCE-3212M	Krypton BCE-4012M	Samsung SW240	SONY CRX-195E1	Yamaha CRW-F1
32X\10X\40X	40X\12X\48X	40X\12X\40X	40X\12X\48X	44X\24X\44X
IDE	IDE	IDE	IDE	IDE
Superlink	Superlink	JustLink	PowerBurn	SAFEburn
Play/Fwd, Eject/Stop, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Play/Fwd, Eject/Stop, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Eject/Stop, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Eject/Stop, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Eject/Stop, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator
2048	2048	8192	1984	8192
3.5	3.5	4	4	2
✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
✗	✗	1	✗	1
1	2	1	✗	✗
NTI CDMaker 5.5.7	NTI CDMaker 5.5.8	Nero 5.5.7.8 and InCD 3.0	Nero 5.5.8.3 and InCD 3.12.0	Nero 5.5.8.17
✗	✗	✓	✗	✓
261.44	255.61	192.51	152.56	250.08
343.76	297.76	283.13	192.63	330.58
224.38	144.23	169.17	166.18	165.79
340.16	464.96	251.54	184.69	331.16
332	336.57	250.96	187.22	327.29
524.41	456.49	438.54	503.85	524.81
520	442.76	440.42	504.35	532.7
14.16	9.87	11.26	13.69	8.71
16.38	19.57	40.54	18.84	18.96
15.35	16.27	38.49	14.06	12.51
8.04	7.64	27.17	12.53	6.57
15.56	23.33	18.7	19.56	19.4
31.46	37.83	31.66	32.19	32.19
41.53	49.94	41.36	42.44	43.45
2879	6144	3501	3564	5120
954	1258	791	867	804
93	88	111	104	100
*	*	*	*	**
2	2	15 months	1	1
13.4	13.4	16.6	9.2	13.8
28.95	33.46	29.42	34.37	31.06
8	8	5	6	5
18.36	17.24	10.23	7.00	4.79
68.71	72.10	61.25	56.57	54.65
A-	A-	B	C+	C
Priya Limited	Priya Limited	Samsung Electronics (SEIIT)	Rashi Peripherals	Neoteric Infomatique
022-2663611	022-2663611	011-6322517	022-8260258	022-4172600
salesbom@priyagroup.com	salesbom@priyagroup.com	marketing@samsungindia.com	ho@rptechindia.com	sales@neoteric-info.com
www.priyagroup.com	www.priyagroup.com	www.samsungindia.com	www.rptechindia.com	www.yamaha.com
3,075	3,625	6,000	8,300	12,500

the rest of the drives had different versions of PowerDVD. The Pioneer drive did not come with any DVD playback software.

Performance

Our performance test covered all areas such as assorted read speed, disk registration test and VOB file extraction test from a DVD media.

We however did not get one drive which performed well across the category—if it performed really well in assorted read speed, it was average in the disk registration test and so on. This was the case with all the drives and because of this we had to look at the overall figure to get a winner in the performance category.

Read tests (DVDs): Movie-watching would be no fun if your DVD-ROM drive is unable to access the data fast enough to provide a smooth experience. Hence, the drive's read speed and access speed becomes critical.

VOB File Extraction: This test helps evaluate the efficiency with which the DVD-ROM drive can copy a DVD on to the hard disk, so that you can play it off the hard disk. We used Flask MPEG v0.594 for this test, which determines the time taken to extract a VOB file into the AVI format using the latest DivX codec. The Samsung SD-616 logged the fastest time—it took 74.38 seconds to complete the extraction process. The Benq DVP-1648A wasn't far behind with 74.61 seconds. The LITEON LTD-165H shocked us by coming last, especially considering that this drive logged the best time in the assorted read test.

Nero DVDSpeed: This is a synthetic benchmark that evaluates multiple parameters that affect the overall performance of a DVD-ROM drive. The first parameter evaluated was the 'seek time'. This refers to the average time taken by the drive to access data from a particular location. It is computed by dividing the time taken to complete a large number of random seeks by the number of seeks performed. If you manage a lot of data either for yourself or for the office on CDs or DVDs, you should look out for this result whenever considering a DVD-ROM drive.

The LITEON LTD 165H logged a seek time of 67 ms. This was an impressive show considering that the runner up, the ASUS DVD E616, logged 169 ms (around 130 per cent more). The slowest in this test was the Sony DDU-16210-C0, which took